

MONEY SHARMA (GETTY IMAGES)

"We would want to win every game in the World Cup but we are starting against Pakistan, so that's going to be special"

SHAFALI VERMA, 17

Cricketer, Rohtak, Haryana

THE BIG HITTER

Shafali Verma announced her arrival in just her second T20 international against South Africa in 2019. Just 15 years old then, she missed out on a half century by four runs but it came off 33 deliveries. Since then, it hasn't taken long for people to start comparing her with former India opener Virender Sehwag.

Shafali walked into an Indian women's cricket dressing room which boasts of many established names, but soon became one of the most talked about batters in the team. Her style of play looks more suited for shorter formats and many had doubts if she could replicate the same success in Tests. But in June this year, she buried those apprehensions with a brilliant 96 in overcast conditions in Bristol, U.K. The ICC Women's World Cup is scheduled for March next year and Shafali, who is still not 18, is already being seen as the X-factor if India are to win their maiden World Cup. ■

–Rahul Rawat

YOUNG 'UN Shafali is the youngest cricketer to represent India internationally in all three formats of the game.

"Lovlina is an epitome of women's empowerment. Her global recognition at the highest level shows there is no knockout for a woman determined to pack a punch"

HIMANTA BISWA SARMA
Chief Minister, Assam

